

vendors chip in with tools and software development kits which normally support their hardware in particular.

Forum.nokia.com is a site that brings together professionals with amateur developers as well as with experts developing applications for Nokia mobile phones. The company provides tools like Software Development Kits (SDKs) for Symbian OS (an operating system for the mobile platform), technical documents, as well as answers to queries specific to the Nokia development platform. Nokia also allows you to test applications with their simulators and testing tools and experts from Nokia help you with application development. Other similar services and initiatives include Ericsson's mobile applications initiative. You can register on the company's site to get educational, technical and marketing support. Microsoft has a similar developer assistance scheme for the developers of Pocket PC (an OS most PDAs use for providing a Windows-like look and feel) applications.

Many of these forums allow you to test your applications. Some even give you tools and you can send in your software for enhancement by experts in the community. Microsoft provides



**If you have an idea for a 'killer app', build a team to develop and sell it to a bigger company**

**Ankur Singh**

Apex Technologies

a Mobile Explorer software to test pages which are to be displayed on a mobile device. Wirelessdevnet.com has channels where after registering one can discuss problems pertaining to specific hardware developments. These forums and communities act as your anchor and make you comfortable in the mobile development world.

### **Mobilespeak**

Developing for mobile devices does not require extraordinary skills, not at least according to Gupta, who says, "Anyone with a basic knowledge of handheld devices and understanding of popular programming languages like C++, Visual Basic, Java or XML can begin developing on the mobile platform".

While developing applications for mobile devices, the work starts on a desktop PC. For example, if you are a Visual Basic professional, you could use Microsoft's Embedded Visual tools (which has Embedded Visual Basic) to develop your application for the mobile device. You could then write the application on your desktop with the SDK from Microsoft and later compile it to make it work on the intended device. The software can be tested on emulators before it's actually ported to the mobile platforms.

Most of the development SDKs are available as free downloads on the Internet, and some of them can be ordered on a CD-ROM from the respective vendor's site. At the most, you might be required to shell out a couple of dollars for shipping charges.

Standalone applications like a simple task organizer for a PDA do not require a major understanding of network standards, but it's desirable to have awareness in case you intend to graduate to development of network-based applications. There are a lot of wireless standards that one needs to know, however. Lavina

1/2 page Ver Ad